

STRATEGIC CONTEXT — THE NEXT 3 MONTHS

The next 3 months are not about broad brand awareness. They are about **building trust, proving product credibility, and converting hype into qualified waitlist and SME demand**. Marketing's role is to create the narrative, proof points, channels, and moments that help Growth build the user base — while staying within regulatory and product-readiness guardrails.

MARKETING STRATEGY

Build **trust first** (licensed bank), **hype second** (AI-native benefits made tangible), and **qualified demand third** (creators, events, PR) — to drive waitlist and SME pipeline growth while staying within regulatory guardrails.

MARKETING GOALS

1M

Waitlist Users (Global)
Growth owns · Mktg contributes 20%+

500K

SME Leads Willing to Provide KYB/KYC (within 2mo of waitlist)
CFO Summit + Offline (Isham) + Direct Network

1M

Social Followers
Benchmark Revolut · Beat WIO · LI-first

20%+

Mktg Contribution to Growth
Every \$ ties to a measurable metric

CBUAE

License (Expected Sep 2026)
AAS = regulator POC · Contingency Nov 1

18

Markets at Wave 1
USD/ACH global · AED = UAE only

Next step: Define timelines, milestones, and quarterly targets for each goal — *how will we get there?* Each figure needs an owner, a deadline, and a measurable path (e.g., 1M waitlist by when? Through which channels? At what cost per signup?).

POSITIONING — HOW WE TALK ABOUT MAL (PRIORITY ORDER)

P0 — LEAD WITH THIS

Licensed Financial Institution

"Clearly a bank — a full bank with a license"
Not a wrapper, not a prepaid card, not an EMI. Always the first thing we say.

P1 — DIFFERENTIATOR

AI-Native Banking

"Open an account in 30 seconds"
AI is not a feature. The entire bank is built on it.

P2 — TRUST LAYER / ETHICAL DIFFERENTIATION

Islamic & Shariah-Compliant

"Ethical banking built in — not bolted on"
Trust layer, not a niche. Shariah compliance earns credibility across audiences — Muslim and non-Muslim.

Global vs UAE: Mal (global) ≠ Mal Bank (UAE/CBUAE). AAS = POC for Public Affairs.

Moat: "Only moat is user-base; everything else is replicable." Must be quantitative.

Messaging: No generic claims. Only flex real experiences. Be quantitative or stay quiet.

CLAIM STATUS LABELS — WHAT CAN WE SAY?

CLAIM	TYPE	STATUS
"Clearly a bank — fully licensed"	Trust	Approved Now
"Open an account in 30 seconds"	AI speed	Product-Proof Required
"Credit limit in 30 seconds"	AI speed	Product-Proof Required
"Never need SWIFT again"	ACH/Global	Post-License Only
"AED 300K at 5%"	Lending	Product-Proof Required
"4x salary"	Lending	Product-Proof Required
"Shariah-compliant banking"	Trust	Approved Now
"Mal pays your bills"	SME	Internal Only

Rule: No claim goes public without product proof or license clearance. "Be quantitative or stay quiet."

AI-NATIVE — WHAT DOES IT ACTUALLY MEAN FOR THE CUSTOMER?

AI CAPABILITY	CUSTOMER BENEFIT
Account opening in seconds	Less friction — no paperwork, no branches
Instant eligibility checks	Faster access to financing — know in seconds, not days
Automated document review	Easier SME onboarding — upload and go
Personalized financial guidance	Better decisions — AI that knows your spending
AI agents (PFM, Tax, CFO)	More useful banking — a bank that works for you

Key: Don't sell "AI." Sell the outcomes. Every AI claim must map to a tangible customer benefit.

OWNERSHIP MATRIX

BUDGET ALLOCATION

GROWTH — 80%

BRAND & MKTG — 20%

Budget: Amine · Growth strategy: Mukund · Hiring: Sama

DOMAIN	OWNER	SCOPE
Growth	Mukund	Userbase, retention, referral, acquisition (80%)
Marketing	Manar, Yasmeen, Isham	Brand, PR, influencers, events, social, TOV, content
Sales / SME	SME Team + Isham	Offline onboarding, CFO Summit, distribution
Product	David, VK, Manar	Demos, tech comms, launches
Public Affairs	AAS	CBUAE comms (UAE-only)
Compliance	Maen + Walid	Risk, regulatory readiness
Hiring	Sama	Marketing team hiring plan
Budgets	Amine	Budget allocation & approval

Rule: Mktg does NOT own growth metrics but must contribute 20%+. Referral program owned by Growth.

INCENTIVE STRATEGY BY SEGMENT

SEGMENT	HOOK	INCENTIVE	PRODUCT ANGLE	CHANNEL
Window Shoppers	"Join waitlist, get paid"	Cash for signup; share LI/IG/X → \$X	Waitlist virality	Social, Paid LI
Adopters	"Try the tech first"	Founder Card + 1-yr sub + beta + community	UI, speed, process	LI Thought Leaders
Retail	"Never need SWIFT again"	Global Accounts first (USD/ACH); 4x salary	Expats EG/TR/IN/PK; lending later (Wave 2–3)	Partnerships, Digital
SMEs	"Upload paperwork — eligible in seconds"	AED 300K at 5%; Mal pays your bills	Bank + Lender one-stop	CFO Summit, Offline

Competitive Stack: FAB = large SMEs, no lending. WIO = tiny SMEs. EFG = lender not bank. **Mal = Bank + Lender. One-stop.**

WAITLIST FUNNEL & GUARDRAILS

Email Only — Weak intent

Email + KYC — Interest

KYC + Referrals — Engagement

Completes Loans — IDEAL

KYC may not be live at waitlist launch. Without KYC, the funnel is hype + referral only — this means we will attract a high volume of **window shoppers** (email-only signups). **That's OK — volume drives the 1M waitlist goal.** Focus positioning on: licensed bank, AI-native, Shariah-compliant. Convert window shoppers into adopters once KYC goes live.

GUARDRAIL	RATIONALE
Clients ≠ Partners	Closes doors (ADNOC = client)
No generic claims	Be quantitative or stay quiet
Mal ≠ Mal Bank	CBUAE only cares about UAE
Only real experiences	"2 seconds" not "we're fast"
90% revenue = lending	Banking acquires, lending generates

WAITLIST HYPE PLAYBOOK

► 10-20 influencers (LI primary, explore IG/X/other platforms)

► Isham identifies influencers & groups per platform with 3rd-party agency

► "UI is great, credit limit in 30 seconds"

► CTA: "I just joined the Mal waitlist and I have 5 slots to give"

► Share to LI/IG/X → get \$X free (package TBD)

► Benchmarks: Revolut, Clubhouse waitlist models

5 Hype Pillars

UI excellence

Authentically Islamic

Product speed

Referral + Founder Card

Private community

CFO SUMMIT & LAUNCH EVENT

CFO Summit

This is not an awareness event. It is a high-intent SME pipeline and credibility engine. Success = qualified SME leads, demos booked, pain points captured, and follow-up pipeline created.

► Top CFOs in ME, 50 max, private round table

► 2-3 VIP speakers (e.g., Hazem)

► "Where are you facing issues with your existing bank?"

► Capture: company info, employees, distribution

► "Mal pays your bills — onboard your vendors"

Media Training

Amine

David

VK

Zigor

Maen+Walid

Youssef

2nd line: Talga, Rideu, Izz

PRODUCT SUITE ROADMAP

	Jun 2026 NOW	Jul 2026 NEXT · WAVE 1	Aug 2026	Sep 2026	Oct 2026 WAVE 2	Nov–Dec 2026 WAVE 3	2027 WAVE 4
RETAIL BANKING	USD Account USD Card USD Payout PKPakistanAEUAEEGEgypt	WAVE 1 LIVE 18 markets · Global Accounts		AED Account AED Card AED Payout AEUAE only	WAVE 2 LIVE AEUAE (post-license)	Credit Card	
SME BANKING	SME USD Account SME USD Card			SME AED Account SME AED Card			

MARKETING ROADMAP — PHASES, LICENSING & EVENTS

	Jun 2026 NOW	Jul 2026 NEXT	Aug 2026	Sep 2026	Oct 2026	Nov–Dec 2026	2027
MARKETING PHASES	Phase 1: Plumbing Internal QA, stress testing, no external comms	Phase 2: Waitlist Hype (Pre-Launch) 5 Hype Pillars · 20-30 influencers (LI, IG/X) · Isham + agency · Referral + Founder Card			Grand Launch Oct 10 (contingency Nov 11)	Scale · Paid acquisition · Lending comms	
LAUNCH COMMS		ACH Launch Comms (Wave 1) GLOBAL "Never need SWIFT again" · Target: EG Egypt · TR Turkey · IN India · PK Pakistan expats			AED Launch Comms (Wave 2) AE UAE · Post-license messaging	Lending product comms (IVF, Tuition, Credit Card) · AE UAE	
LICENSING & EVENTS			CFO Summit 50 pax · Top CFOs in ME · Private round table · TBD Aug–Dec	CBUAE License AE Expected. If delayed → Nov 1	Launch Event Oct 10 or Nov 11		

IMMEDIATE ACTION ITEMS				
#	OWNER(S)	ACTION	PRIORITY	STATUS
1	AAS + Walid	Roadmap + product suite sign-off, share with team	URGENT	FINAL STAGES
2	Manar + Yasmeen + Isham	Brainstorm marketing and incentive strategy, PR strategy, branding	URGENT	PENDING
3	Manar + Yasmeen + Isham	Brainstorm CFO Summit + Launch Event (Oct 10 / contingency Nov 11)	URGENT	PENDING
4	Manar	Budget allocations: marketing, brand, sales, growth (Amine approves)	HIGH	PENDING
5	Yasmeen + Walid	Schedule calls between Manar and GA team vs other product leads	HIGH	IN PROGRESS
6	Isham (lead) + Yasmeen (content)	Define waitlist referral package (share to LI/IG/X → \$X reward)	HIGH	PENDING
7	Isham + 3rd-party agency	Identify 10-20 influencers & groups per platform for paid hype	HIGH	PENDING
8	Marketing Team	Get to 1M waitlist users (incentive + ACH/USD — excl. sanctioned markets)	HIGH	PENDING
9	Marketing Team	Internal corporate comms + assets (brand DNA, gifting, decks, attire)	MEDIUM	PENDING
10	Mukund	Growth budget request strategy (Amine = budget holder)	MEDIUM	PENDING
11	Sama / Amine	Hiring plan for marketing team (Sama = hiring, Amine = budget)	MEDIUM	PENDING

CRITICAL PATH	25 products · 4 waves · 18 markets
Plumbing (Jun) → Waitlist Hype → Wave 1 USD (Jul) → Invoice Factoring (Aug) → License (Sep) → Launch Event + Wave 2 (Oct) → Wave 3 (Nov–Dec) → AI Agents (2027)	Confidential · Internal use only